

● EASY

● STANDARD ENGLISH CONVENTIONS

● ANSWER KEY

Form, Structure, and Sense

07

10 answers · Rationale-rich · Teach from doc

Q1**D****D. ensures**

Choice D is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "ensures" agrees in number with the singular subject "using."

Choice A is incorrect because the plural verb "are ensuring" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "using." Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb "have ensured" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "using." Choice C is incorrect because the plural verb "ensure" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "using."

Q2**A****A. Moon's**

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of possessive nouns. The singular possessive noun "Moon's" correctly indicates that there is only one Moon, and it has a gravitational pull.

Choice B is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun "Moon's," not the plural noun "Moons." Choice C is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun "Moon's," not the plural possessive noun "Moons'." Choice D is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive noun "Moon's," not the singular noun "Moon."

Q3

C

C. has been

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb “has been” agrees in number with the singular subject “writing.”

Choice A is incorrect because the plural verb “were” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “writing.” Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb “have been” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “writing.” Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb “are” doesn’t agree in number with the singular subject “writing.”

Q4

A

A. its wings

Choice A is the best answer. The conventions being tested are the use of possessive determiners and plural nouns. The singular possessive determiner “its” and the plural noun “wings” correctly indicate that the butterfly has multiple wings.

Choice B is incorrect because the context requires the plural noun “wings,” not the plural possessive noun “wings’.” Choice C is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive determiner “its” and the plural noun “wings,” not the contraction “it’s” and the singular possessive noun “wing’s.” Choice D is incorrect because the context requires the singular possessive determiner “its” and the plural noun “wings,” not the contraction “it’s” and the plural possessive noun “wings’.”

Q5**C****C. stands**

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The singular verb "stands" agrees in number with the singular subject "sculpture."

Choice A is incorrect because the plural verb "are standing" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "sculpture." Choice B is incorrect because the plural verb "have been standing" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "sculpture." Choice D is incorrect because the plural verb "were standing" doesn't agree in number with the singular subject "sculpture."

Q6**B****B. to study**

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms within a sentence. The nonfinite to-infinitive verb "to study" is correctly used to form a subordinate clause that indicates what Dr. Caballero-Gill uses chemistry and fossil evidence for (to study oceans as they were in the past).

Choice A is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite verb "has studied" can't be used in this way to form a subordinate clause that indicates what Dr. Caballero-Gill uses the evidence for. Choice C is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite verb "studied" can't be used in this way to form a subordinate clause that indicates what Dr. Caballero-Gill uses the evidence for. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The finite verb "studies" can't be used in this way to form a subordinate clause that indicates what Dr. Caballero-Gill uses the evidence for.

Q7**C****C. this**

Choice C is the best answer. The convention being tested is pronoun-antecedent agreement. The singular pronoun "this" agrees in number with the singular antecedent "Lê Luông Minh became the thirteenth secretary-general of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) in January 2013." The pronoun "this" is referring back to the singular event described earlier in the sentence in which Minh became secretary-general of ASEAN.

Choice A is incorrect because the plural pronoun "these" doesn't agree in number with the singular antecedent "Lê Luông Minh became the thirteenth secretary-general of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) in January 2013." Choice B is incorrect because the plural pronoun "those" doesn't agree in number with the singular antecedent "Lê Luông Minh became the thirteenth secretary-general of the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) in January 2013." Choice D is incorrect because the indefinite pronoun "some" is ambiguous in this context; the resulting sentence leaves unclear what marks the first time the organization appointed a Vietnamese leader.

Q8**B****B. themselves**

Choice B is the best answer. The convention being tested is pronoun-antecedent agreement. The plural reflexive pronoun "themselves" agrees in number with the plural antecedent "turtle barnacles," correctly indicating what is attached to a sea turtle shell.

Choice A is incorrect because the singular pronoun "it" doesn't agree in number with the plural antecedent "turtle barnacles." Choice C is incorrect because it results in an unclear and confusing sentence. In this context, it's unclear what the plural pronoun "them" refers to. Choice D is incorrect because the singular reflexive pronoun "itself" doesn't agree in number with the plural antecedent "turtle barnacles."

Q9**A****A. published**

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of verb forms within a sentence. A main clause requires a finite (tensed) verb to perform the action of the subject (in this case, Nery and her colleagues), and this choice supplies the finite past tense verb "published" to indicate that these biologists shared their findings about changes in whale genes associated with body size.

Choice B is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite participle "publishing" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice C is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite participle "having published" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite to-infinitive "to publish" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb.

Q10**B****B. became**

Choice B is the best answer. The conventions being tested are the use of verbs to express tense and the use of verb forms within a sentence. In this choice, the past tense verb "became" is consistent with the other past tense verbs ("owned," "operated," and "was") used to indicate that, at a period of time in the past, Bass's leadership resulted in her newspaper becoming one of the most influential Black-owned newspapers in the US. In addition, "became" supplies the main clause with a finite (tensed) verb, which is required to perform the action of the subject (in this case, *The Eagle*).

Choice A is incorrect because the future tense verb "will become" isn't consistent with the other past tense verbs used to discuss Bass and her newspaper. Choice C is incorrect because the present progressive verb "is becoming" isn't consistent with the other past tense verbs used to discuss Bass and her newspaper. Choice D is incorrect because it results in an ungrammatical sentence. The nonfinite to-infinitive "to become" doesn't supply the main clause with a finite verb.

Notes

Accept equivalent forms (e.g. $0.25 \equiv 1/4$). For grid-in items, decimal and fraction answers are both valid.

Generated 2026-05-29 · cb-educator-question-bank